The debate about invasive species has been quite decisive within the scientific community. Source 1 (lines 8, 14-15) demonstrates that idea through the perspective of Jason Gleditsch. Gleditsch had done research into potential benefits to invasive species, but was met with a lot of pushback. There seem to be two sides of the debate. The first side is that invasive species have negative impacts on the world, while the other side might say they actually hold benefits. Either way, the debate begs the question if it is necessary to control invasive species. According to the points referenced in the sources, it is necessary to control invasive species due to negative side effects on the environment, people, and while some may argue some invasive species are good, the beneficial impacts cannot be accessed without more research.

Often, the first point that jumps to mind when debating invasive species are the impacts on the environment. Source 2 provides the details to a couple of species invasions, one of which was the Burmese Python invasion of the everglades. Source 2 states that many people released their pet pythons, however, because they don't have many natural predators in the Everglades, they have destroyed the ecosystem. (lines 13-16) Source 2 goes on to illustrate that the Python eat many local species, disturbing the balance (line 16). The Burmese Python invasion of the Everglades goes to show just how devastating one invasive species can be to an ecosystem. Imagine stricter policies were in place to

stop people from releasing their pythons or if [redacted] less people had access to them. In that case, the invasion would have been much less likely to occur and the ecosystem would still be in balance. Source 2 brings up another example of invasive species in cats that were brought to South Africa. Specifically, cats were imported to an island called "Marion Island" as a control for the mice. However, the [redacted] five cats that had been brought over, rose to a population of about 3,400 in 28 years. This rise in cat population endangered local bird species, [redacted] creating a disaster (Source 2, lines 9-12). Stricter control over invasive species would decrease the likelihood of events like those [redacted] detailed in source 2 from happening. Without control, the environment is in danger from invasive species.

Though the environment is important, it is also important to consider the impacts on people. Source 3 introduces the idea of [redacted] "human endeavors" like forestry and fisheries being damaged (Source 3, line 17). If people lose jobs [redacted] or can not make enough money to survive because of an invasive species, then something needs to be done. Control of invasive species would help prevent that from happening. Another concern Source 3 addresses is the spread of pathogens. Whether it be invasive pathogens introduced or invasive species that carry them, people are harmed (Source 3, lines 18-19). Source 3 also states that biological invasions estimated to cost the United States, "over $100 billion annually" [redacted] (Source 3, line 23). Source 3 clearly demonstrates that

invasive species do more than harm the environment, as they also allow for the spread of pathogens, potentially killing people, and harm the economy, reducing jobs. Invasive species control helps stop these issues from becoming widespread, illustrating the necessity for it.

On the other hand, some might claim that invasive species can actually benefit the environment. Source 1 gives readers insight to a researcher named Jason Gleditsch. Gleditsch did research into an invasive honeysuckle plant. He found that the plant actual positively effected its surroundings, increasing the population of native species (Source 1, lines 8-12). Source 1 also provides a story about ladybugs. It states, "ladybugs helped devour pests afflicting native trees on the island of St. Helena" (Source 1, lines 46-47). Source one states that this saved the species from extinction showing invasive species can help the environment. Keeping these good examples of invasive species in mind, it now becomes less clear on whether or not to control invasive species. However, according to Source 3, introducing species has an unpredictable outcome of events (lines 24-26). Source 3 continues by stating multiple examples where the effects of an invasive species could not be predicted. One specific example was the British introduction of the mongoose to manage the rabbit population. The introduction of the mongoose ultimately led to the extinction of the large blue butterfly (Source 3, lines 30-31). Source 3 demonstrates the greatest issue with not controlling invasive species, nature is too unpredictable. While some species might end up having positive effects, it is virtually impossible to know

beforehand. Nature is a powerful force, and source 3 shows that if people aren't careful, entire species could be eradicated and ecosystems destroyed. Hence, control of invasive species is necessary because even scientists cannot predict what will happen, meaning the risks outweigh the potential benefits.

Overall, both sides of the invasive species debate hold merit. However, considering the arguments presented in each source, it is just too risky to not control invasive species because of the impacts they have on the environment people, and the unknown possibilities. While yes, it is important to keep in mind potential benefits of invasive species, it is simply irresponsible to let them go around uncontrolled. Considering this, source 3 does provide a solution, which is more research. If more research is done such that scientists are able to predict outcomes of implementing invasive species, then it would be possible to get the benefits of mixing and matching species without the drawbacks (lives 321-992). Until that time, it is of utmost importance to enforce strict control over invasive species.